2026 WEST ZONE CHAMPIONSHIPS

Senior, Junior, Youth, 12&U, AWD
North Natomas Aquatic Center
2601 New Market Dr., Sacramento, CA 95835
March 5-8, 2026

FINAL MEET ANNOUNCEMENT

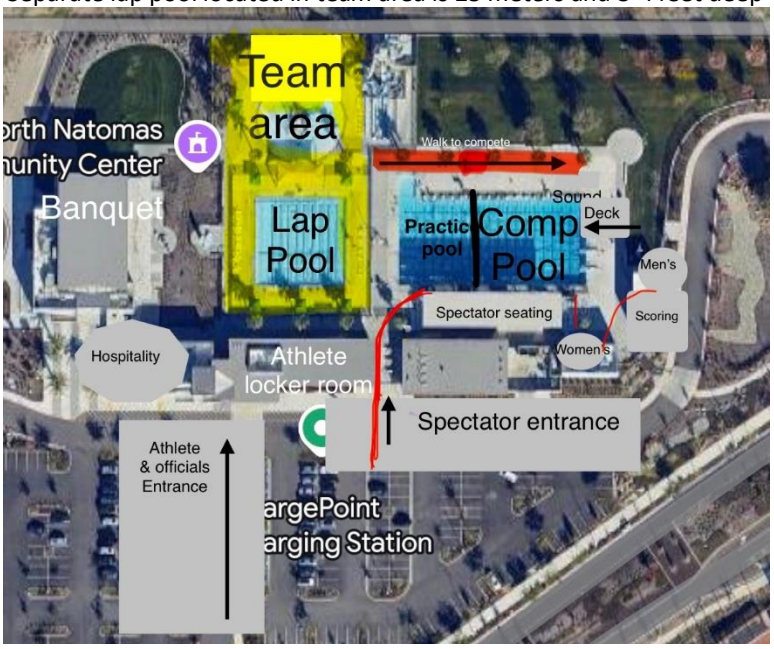
MEET HOST: Pacific Artistic Swimming

MEET MANAGERS: Heather Wartanyan, coachheatherssst@gmail.com, (916) 880-6157
Patricia Jones, mailforpj@aol.com, (831) 419-5818
WZ Tech Chair: Kristen Smidstra, admin@aquanuts.org, (925) 395-1524

ZONE CHAIRS: Admin Chair: Patricia Jones
Technical Chair: Kristen Smidstra
Officials Chair: Shannon Korpela
Education Chair: Leslie Perez Palma
DEI Chair: Tina Boales
Scoring Chair: Rick Clancy

FACILITY: North Natomas Aquatic Center
2601 New Market Dr., Sacramento, CA 95835

POOL SPECS: Outdoor Competition Pool:
Length: 50 meters
Width: 25 yards
Competition area is 13 feet deep lanes 1-5, then slopes up to 7 feet deep for the remainder of the competition area
Warm up area is all 7 feet deep
Athletes will walk out forward, approximately 12 feet for walk on.
Stacks and lifts are allowed
Separate lap pool located in team area is 25 meters and 3-4 feet deep



PARKING: Parking is available at the facility at no extra cost.

EXTRA POOL TIME: Pool time availability for practice on Thursday morning, March 5th, has been reduced to two hours, between 7:00 am and 9:00 am, due to an earlier start for competition that day. Those clubs that submitted reservations by the deadline will be notified by Kristen Smidstra or Heather Wartanyan of their assigned times.

AIRPORT:

CLOSEST MAJOR AIRPORT
Sacramento International Airport (SMF)
https://flysmf.gov
7 miles from pool

GROUND TRANS:
All major rental car companies onsite
https://flysmf.gov/to-and-from/rental-car
Ride share info
https://flysmf.gov/to-and-from/app-based-ride-share

HOTEL INFORMATION: No host hotel room blocks are available for this meet. There are multiple hotels within a 5 to 15 minute drive from the pool, most offering complimentary airport shuttle service and free breakfast. Some suggestions include:

- Homewood Suites by Hilton Sacramento Airport-Natomas
  https://www.hilton.com/en/hotels/saccahw-homewood-suites-sacramento-airport-natomas/?seo_id=yextn-amer-hg-saccahw&y_source=1_mja4mzu1oc03njktbg9jyxrpb24ud2vic2l0zq==
- Hampton Inn & Suites Sacramento-Airport-Natomas
  https://www.hilton.com/en/hotels/sacnnhx-hampton-suites-sacramento-airport natomas/?SEO_id=YEXTN-AMER-HX-SACNNHX&y_source=1_MjA4MzU4MS03NjktbG9jYXRpb24ud2Vic2l0ZQ==
- Hyatt House Sacramento Airport / Natomas
  https://www.hyatt.com/hyatt-house/en-US/sacxn-hyatt-house-sacramento-airport-natomas?hid=HYATT-SACXN
- Holiday Inn Express & Suites Sacramento Airport Natomas
  https://www.ihg.com/holidayinnexpress/hotels/us/en/sacramento/sacdp/hotel detail?cm_mmc=yextlocal-_-ex-_-us-_-sacdp
- Wyndham Garden Sacramento Airport Natomas
  https://www.wyndhamhotels.com/wyndham-garden/sacramento-california/wyndham-garden-sacramento-airport-natomas/overview
- Hilton Garden Inn Sacramento Airport Natomas
  https://www.hilton.com/en/hotels/sacangi-hilton-garden-inn-sacramento-airport-natomas/?SEO_id=YEXTN-AMER-GI-SACANGI&y_source=1_MTI0Mzc0OTctNzY5LWxvY2F0aW9uLndlYnNpdGU=
- TownePlace Suites by Marriott Sacramento Airport Natomas
  https://www.marriott.com/en-us/hotels/sacta-towneplace-suites-sacramento-airport-natomas/overview/

FACILITY RULES:

SNACK BAR: No snack bar available. There are multiple restaurants/fast food establishments and grocery stores within a few minutes of the pool.

FOOD: Teams may bring in their own food (no glass containers allowed) to set up in the team area. There is food allowed in spectator seating; however, there is no food allowed on deck.

TABLES/CANOPIES: Clubs who bring their own canopies must bring their own buckets and/or tie-downs to secure them. Reservations to rent tables and pop-up canopies are now closed and there is no guarantee that we can accommodate additional requests; however, you may contact Patricia Jones directly at mailforpj@aol.com if you are still in need of these.

GELLING: There will be a designated knoxing station at the facility. Please do not knox anywhere else. There is to be no knoxing or deknoxing or washing out brushes/bowls in the bathrooms. If anyone does deknox in the bathroom or pool, there will be a $100 fine per incident. The facility does not allow any deknoxing onsite.

RULES TO GOVERN:

Championships shall be held in accordance with Zone Rules, Article 10, as listed in the current Rulebook. A copy of Article 10 is included in this notice.

ENTRY DEADLINE:

Entry deadline is **02/12/2026**.

Late Entries: Late entries to the West Zone Championships may be accepted at the discretion of the Host Organization, the Zone Chair and the Zone Technical Chair. There shall be a fine imposed upon any club whose late entry is accepted in the amount of $50, payable to the Host Organization.

ENTRY PROCEDURES:

CAREFULLY FOLLOW THE INSTRUCTIONS BELOW FOR SUBMITTING YOUR ENTRY FORM

Questions? Contact Patricia Jones at mailforpj@aol.com

- Each team must upload their Meet Entry Form to their respective team folder.
- Note: Each team has one designated owner for their team folders; those owners will be sent an email invitation to be editor of their team folders. That owner may grant access to others on the team, but they are responsible for all access and activity in their team folder, so only share access with great caution. We recommend you funnel all forms to the designated team representative, and that rep owns uploading.
- Use the 2026 WZ Champs Meet Entry Form included in the email with this Final Meet Announcement. **You must submit your entry on this Excel form;** do not use Google Sheets.
- Do not use Apple products to fill out this form.
- Do not add/remove/rename sheets in this form.
- Do not insert or delete rows.
- Do not leave empty lines when you are listing your athletes.
- You may copy and paste **ONLY** the following information: Reg Number (may use full USAA-number or just the number itself), Athlete First Name, Athlete Last Name, Birth Year.
- Use the drop-down menus for all other columns on the form.
- If you have a swimmer competing in multiple age divisions, such as Youth, Junior and Senior, you must enter that swimmer on a separate line for each division. Note the difference by adding a letter after their first name. For example, Jane Doe is swimming Youth, as well as a Junior event and a Senior event; enter her on separate

lines as “Doe, Jane Y”, “Doe, Jane J”, “Doe, Jane S”, and each of those rows should only list the routines she is competing in that specific age division.

- Upload the completed meet entry form to the Google folder for your team.
- **Meet Entry folders will close at 11:59 PST on 02/12/2026** and all access will be removed.
- Late Entries: If a late entry is approved, the entry form must be emailed to Patricia Jones at mailforpj@aol.com

FEES:

Entry Fee	$10 per competitor per event
Alternate Entry Fee	$5 for each listed alternate in any routine
Sponsor Fee	$35 per competitor
Additional Credential Fee	$10 each
West Zone Dinner Fee	$30 per attendee

PAYMENT INSTRUCTIONS:
Zelle your payment to pacificartisticswimtreasurer@gmail.com
or mail check made payable to PASS to
PASS
c/o Leslie Perez Palma
156 Okinawa Rd.
Seaside, CA 93955

PAYMENT DEADLINE: **Due 02/19/2026** Payments received after this date will be subject to a late payment fine(s), as follows:
Late Payment of Entry Fees:
1) $25.00 (to the Host Organization) for club entry payments not received by the West Zone Championships payment deadline.
2) An additional $50.00 (to the Host Organization) for club entry payments not received until arrival at the West Zone Championships, for a total of $75.00.

SCRATCHES: Coaches must report scratches and changes **in writing** to Scoring Chair Rick Clancy a **minimum of two (2) hours prior to the start of the scheduled event.**

EVENT DEFINITIONS:
Solos consist of Women, Men, and Gender Inclusive
Duets consist of Women, Men, Gender Inclusive, and Mixed
Team, Acrobatic and Free Combination are open events (no gender restriction)

EVENTS:
Senior tech and free events in Solo, Duet, and Team
Junior tech and free events in Solo, Duet, and Team
Junior/Senior Acrobatic Routine
16-19 Combo
Youth events in Figures, Solo, Duet, Team, and Free Combination
12&Under events in Figures, Solo, Duet, Team, and Free Combination
AWD events in Solo, Duet, Trio and Team

- There will be no practice with music.
- Figures
  12&Under athletes will do 2 figures, using 4 judging panels
  Youth athletes will do 2 figures, using 4 judging panels
  The figure draw will be done by the WZ Technical Chair on Monday, March 2nd

- Bonus Entries: The numbers in the table below are in addition to the top six routines that qualify in each event.

Bonus Entry Table for 2026 Events

Event	Championship	Solo	Duet	Team
U.S. National	U.S. National Tech	East 3 West 4 North 2 South 3	East 1 West 7 North 1 South 3	East 2 West 2 North 0 South 0
U.S. National	U.S. National Free	East 3 West 5 North 2 South 2	East 1 West 2 North 1 South 1	East 2 West 1 North 0 South 1
U.S. Junior	U.S. Junior Tech	East 3 West 8 North 1 South 0	East 3 West 7 North 1 South 1	East 1 West 6 North 2 South 3
U.S. Junior	U.S. Junior Free	East 3 West 8 North 1 South 0	East 2 West 6 North 1 South 3	East 2 West 6 North 1 South 3
U.S. Youth	U.S. Youth	East 1 West 7 North 1 South 3	East 1 West 8 North 1 South 2	East 1 West 7 North 0 South 4

ELIGIBILITY:

No qualifying meets or scores for any event

Senior competitors must be 15 years of age or older based on the year of birth (born in 2011 or earlier)

Exception: Competitors who are 13-14 years of age may be combined with competitors who are 15 & over in order to enter Senior Team and Acrobatic Routine events in Zone Championships. Competitors in Team Technical, Team Free and the Acrobatic Routine events in Senior Zone Championships, who have passed Grade Level 6, shall be eligible for the U.S. National Championship.

Junior Female competitors must be 15 to 19 years of age based on the year of birth (born between 2007 – 2011)

Junior Male competitors must be 15 to 20 years of age based on the year of birth (born between 2006 – 2011)

Exception: Competitors who are 13-14 years of age may be combined with competitors who are 15-19/20 in order to enter Junior Team and Acrobatic Routine events in Zone Championships. Competitors in Team Technical, Team Free and the Acrobatic Routine events in Junior Zone Championships, who have passed Grade Level 5, shall be eligible for the U.S. Junior Championship.

Youth Female competitors must be 13 to 15 years of age based on the year of birth (born between 2011 – 2013)

Youth Male competitors must be 13 to 16 years of age based on the year of birth (born 2010 – 2013)

Exception: Competitors who are 12 years of age and younger may be combined with competitors who are 13-15/16 in order to enter Youth Team and Free Combination Routine events in Zone Championships. Competitors in Team and the Free Combination Routine events in Youth Zone Championships, who have passed Grade Level 4, shall be eligible for the U.S. Youth Championship.

12&Under competitors must be 12 years or younger based on the year of birth (born in 2014 or later)

MUSIC DEADLINE:

Music submission deadline is **02/19/2026.**

Late Music Submission: Music submissions or changes to music after 02/19/2025 are subject to a $25 late fee per incident.

MUSIC PROCEDURES:

Music files should be emailed to Patricia Jones at mailforpj@aol.com

Digital music files (M4A, MP3) are to be submitted for routines for this competition.

- We recommend submitting 160+ kbit/sec M4A/AAC or higher quality audio for best sound results. If sending MP3 files, 192+ kbit/sec is recommended.
- Please have a minimum one-second leader (silence) before the music starts.
- A device with a 1/8" TRS (headphone) jack (phone, iPod, iPad/tablet) is acceptable as a backup device. You may also use a CD as backup.
- Use the following naming conventions when saving files:
  Youth Duet ADG Cunningham. Routines should be "space" separated.
  o Youth (Competition Division)
  o Duet = Routine event. Please indicate Free or Technical for Jr and Sr events
  o ADG = Club Abbreviation/Three Letter Code
  o Cunningham = Last name of the first alphabetical member of the routine

Music Time Measurement: https://measure-routines.web.app/measure_routines.html

COACH CARD DEADLINE: Coach Card submission deadline is **02/19/2026.**
Late Coach Card Submissions: Late coach cards or changes to cards after 02/19/2026 are subject to a $25 late fee per incident. **NO** coach card submissions or changes will be allowed after 02/26/2026, except on medical grounds.

COACH CARD PROCEDURES: **CAREFULLY FOLLOW THE INSTRUCTIONS BELOW FOR SUBMITTING COACH CARDS**
Questions? Contact Patricia Jones at mailforpj@aol.com

- **Make absolutely certain** that you are using the latest version of the Coach Card from the USAAS scoring site.
- Upload your completed Coach Cards to the Google folder for your team.
- **Coach Card folders will close at 11:59 PST on 02/19/2026** and all access will be removed.
- Late Submissions: If a new and/or changed Coach Card needs to be submitted after the deadline, the Coach Card must be emailed to Patricia Jones at mailforpj@aol.com

CREDENTIALS: Only credentialed athletes, coaches, and officials will be allowed in the competition area. Only credentialed athletes, coaches, chaperones and officials will be allowed in the team area. We will be checking to make sure all coaches, chaperones, and officials are at the appropriate level. Each Club will receive Chaperone and Coach credentials per the table below. Additional credentials can be purchased at $10 each. There will be a $25 credential late fee assessed for credentials requested "at the door" by coaches/chaperones who did not pre-register.

MAXIMUM NUMBER OF CREDENTIALS

# of Athletes	# of Coaches Credentials	# of Chaperone Credentials
1-10	2	1
11-15	3	2
16-20	4	2
21-25	5	3
26-30	6	3
31-35	7	4
36-40	8	4
41-45	9	5
46-50	10	5

PLEASE NOTE: A $100 fine may be assessed per incident against any person and/or club who has received one warning to leave the competition or team area and does not do so.

COACHES: All Coaches on deck must be members of USA Artistic Swimming, must be certified as a level CCP-2 Coach or higher, must be current in their CPR/FA, must have completed the Background Check, and must be SafeSport Certified. This will be strictly enforced. All requirements need to be completed by **02/19/2026.** If you have any questions regarding coaches certification and waivers, please email Leslie Perez Palma at leslienat18@gmail.com. Breakfast and lunch will be provided for Coaches.

OFFICIALS: All Officials on deck must be members of USA Artistic Swimming, must be certified as a Level 3 Official or higher, must have completed the Background Check, and must be SafeSport Certified. This will be strictly enforced. All requirements need to be completed by **02/19/2026.** If you have any questions regarding your standing as an official, please email Shannon Korpela at skorpela28@gmail.com. Breakfast and lunch will be provided for Judges and Officials. Judges are expected to wear black bottoms (shorts, skirt, pants) and a white top.

CHAPERONES: All Chaperones on deck must be members of USA Artistic Swimming, must have completed the Background Check, and must be Safe Sport Certified. This will be strictly enforced. All requirements need to be completed by **02/19/2026.** Chaperones are not allowed on deck, only in the team area.

SPECIALTY COACHES: All adjuncts to a team's coaching program, such as an athletic trainer, must be members of USA Artistic Swimming, must have completed the Background Check, and be SafeSport certified. All requirements need to be completed by **02/19/2026.** Specialty Coaches are not allowed on deck, only in the team area.

ATHLETES: All Athletes must be members of USA Artistic Swimming and must have a signed Waiver in their Sport:80 profile. Minor athletes must be registered as a Youth Competitive Athlete. Any athlete who will turn 18 prior to August 31, 2026, must be registered as an Adult Competitive Athlete. Any athlete who will turn 18 prior to March 9, 2026, must be SafeSport certified. This will be strictly enforced. All requirements need to be completed by **02/19/2026.**

SPECTATOR TICKETS: One day $10 for adults, $5 for children/students/age 65+
For all days $30 for adults, $15 for children/students/age 65+

There will be a Spectator Entrance where tickets may be purchased.
Payment for tickets may be made by cash, check or Zelle.
Spectators will not be allowed on the competition deck. If a spectator is found to be in violation of this rule, they will be asked to leave. Refunds will not be given.

VENDORS: There will be vendor on site selling 2026 West Zone Championships merchandise.

WEBCAST: Takeitlive.tv will be on site to provide live stream video of this event for your families and friends to watch online.

PHOTOS/VIDEOS: No spectators will be allowed on deck to take photos or videos. Please film from the spectator bleachers or outside the facility.

WZ MEETING & DINNER: The WZ Annual meeting and Athlete Dinner will take place on Friday, March 6th, 6:30-8:00 pm, at the North Natomas Community Center, adjacent to the pool.

Note: An Association shall be fined $25 if the Association has competitors in the West Zone Championship and the Administrative Chair, or appointed representative, does not attend the West Zone Annual Meeting.

WZ AWARDS: Please submit your nominations for the West Zone Athlete, Coach, and Contributor of the year on the attached form ***no later than January 31, 2026***. Send to Irene Hawes at the email address noted on the form. It is very important to receive these nominations in a timely fashion so that the awards can be presented during the West Zone Championships.

SCHEDULE CHANGES: Schedule may be adjusted based on the final entry numbers. The Sunday schedule may be extended, or the order of events may change on the indicated day. Warm-ups for each group in each event will occur at least 15 minutes prior to the start of each group. A reasonable effort will be made for athletes that swim in both Senior and Junior categories not to compete in back to back events.

TENTATIVE SCHEDULE: **A final detailed schedule will be sent once final entries are received.**

Thursday March 5	
7-9	Fee Based Training
7:15-9:15	Level 3 Judge test
8-10	Registration
9-9:30	Coaches/Officials meeting
9-9:30	Lap Swim
9:30-10:00	Junior Female Tech Solo (30), Senior Female Tech Solo (9), Jr Male Tech solo (2) Warm Up
10:05-1:20	Junior Female Tech Solo, Senior Female Tech Solo, Jr Male Tech solo Competition
1:20-1:35	Youth male(4), Youth Female Solo warm up (27)
1:40-4:05	Youth Male, Female Solo competition
4:05-4:20	Junior Female Free Solo(29), Senior Female Free Solo (10) Jr Male Free solo (1) Warm Up.
4:25-7:45	Junior Female Free Solo, Senior Female Free, Sr Male Free Solo Competition
Friday March 6	
8-8:30	Lap Swim **at 8:10 synchro laps may start.
8:30-8:40	12/U Figure Warm Up (62)
8:45-9:20	12/U Figure Competition. Practice pool open for QUIET routine and figure work. If coaching voices get too loud, coaches will not be allowed on the warm up side until 12/U and Youth figures are over.
9:20-9:40	Youth Figure Warm Up *140* (2x10 min warm-ups; half the amount of swimmers from each team in each warm-up.)
9:45-11:05	Youth Figure Competition. Practice pool open for QUIET routine and figure work. If coaching voices get too loud, coaches will not be allowed on the warm up side until Youth figures are over.
11:05-11:20	Sr (7) /Jr (21) Duet Tech Warm up
11:25-1:45	Sr/Jr Duet Tech Competition

1:45-2:15	Break
2:15-2:35	12/U Combo(2); Youth Combo (8) ; 16-19 Combo (3) warm up (1 16-19 swimming Saturday) **2x10 min warm-ups**
2:40-4:00	12/u, Youth Combo, 16-19 Competition
4:00-4:30	Jr (12), Sr (4) Tech Team warm up **3x10 min warm-ups**
4:35-6:05	Jr, Sr Tech Team Competition
6:30-8	West Zone dinner
Saturday March 7	
7-7:30	Lap Swim
7:30-7:45	Sr Mixed Duet Tech (1) and Jr mixed duet tech (1) 12/U male (2), female solo (11) warm up
7:50-9:05	Sr Mixed Duet Tech Competition, 12/U male, female solo competition
9:05-9:15	AWD Trio (1) warm up
9:20-9:25	AWD Trio competition
9:25-9:35	Acro (6) and 16-19 Combo (1) warm up
9:40-10:25	Acro Competition, 1 16-19 Combo out of order
10:25-10:35	AWD Solo (8) warm up
10:40-11:00	AWD solo competition
11:00-11:30	Break/AWD Awards
11:30-12:00	12/U (11), Youth (23) Duet warm up , Male Youth duet (1); gender inclusive Youth duet (1) **2x15 min warm ups**
12:05-3:25	12/U; Youth Female, Male, Gender Inclusive Duet Competition
3:25-3:55	Jr(24) , Sr (10), Free Duet Warm up **2x15 min warm ups**
4:00-7:05	Jr, Sr Free Duet competition
Sunday March 8	**NOTE: WE ARE NOW ON DAYLIGHT SAVINGS TIME**
8:00-8:30	Lap Swim
8:30-8:45	12/U, Youth, Jr Free Mixed Duet Warm up Youth (4), 12/U (3), Jr Mixed Free Duet (1)
8:50-9:45	12/U, Youth, Jr, Mixed Free Duet Competition
9:45-10:25	12U Mixed Team (8) , Youth Mixed Team Warm Up (14) **4x 10 min warm ups**
10:30-12:40	12U Mixed Team, Youth Mixed Team Competition
12:40-1:00	Junior Mixed Free Team (5), Senior Mixed Free Team (2) **2x10 min warm ups**
1:05-1:55	Junior Mixed Free Team, Senior Mixed Free Team Competition
2:15	Awards

ARTICLE 10
WEST ZONE CHAMPIONSHIP RULES

10.01 A West Zone Championship shall be held every year, the championship to commence on the first Thursday in March, with competition in Senior, Junior and Youth divisions, and conducted according to the Rules governing USAAS where not specifically addressed in the West Zone Rules.

10.02 The West Zone Championships shall serve as the qualifying meet for West Zone Athlete members to U.S. Nationals, U.S. Junior Championship and/or U.S. Youth Championship.

10.03 An Athlete member may enter only one (1) of the four (4) Zone Championships each year.

10.04

A. **Senior Championship**

1. Senior Division Qualifiers
   a. Athletes entering must be 15 years of age or older based on the year of birth.
      Exception: Competitors who are 13 and 14 years of age may compete in Team Technical and Team Free routines. Routines including competitors who are 13 and 14 years of age are also eligible to participate in Team Technical and Team Free routines at the U.S. National Championship; however, they must have passed Grade Level 6. At least 1 competitor in Team Technical and Team Free routines must be in the Senior Age division.
   b. There are no qualifying meets or scores for this competition.
2. Senior Division Events
   a. Competition shall consist of Technical routines and Free routines for Solo (Women, Men, and Gender Inclusive), Duet (Women, Men, Gender Inclusive, and Mixed), and Team events.
   b. The Technical and Free routines are individual events and each of the two events shall advance the appropriate number of qualified placements to U.S. Nationals.
   c. Technical and Free routines shall be considered Final Events.
   d. Senior Free routines in each event may be conducted as a combined group with the Junior Free routines, with no change in judges or scoring personnel during the routine event.
3. Senior Division Awards
   a. Medals shall be awarded for places 1-3 and ribbons shall be awarded for places 4-8 in each of the events noted under A.2.a.
   b. The West Zone shall award a High Point Award (plaque) to the Club with the highest total points earned in the Senior Championship.

B. **Junior Championship**

1. Junior Division Qualifiers
   a. Athletes entering must be 15 to 19 (for females) and 15-20 (for males and for solo and duet gender inclusive competitors) years of age based on the year of birth.
      Exception: Competitors who are 13 and 14 years of age may compete in Team Technical and Team Free routines. Routines including competitors who are 13 and 14 years of age are also eligible to participate in Team Technical and Team Free routines at the U.S. Junior Championship; however, they must have passed Grade Level 5. At least 1 competitor in Team Technical and Team Free routines must be in the Junior Age division.
   b. There are no qualifying meets or scores for this competition.
2. Junior Division Events
   a. Competition shall consist of Technical routines and Free routines for Solo (Women, Men, and Gender Inclusive), Duet (Women, Men, Gender Inclusive, and Mixed), and Team events.
   b. The Technical and Free routines are individual events and each of the two events shall advance the appropriate number of qualified placements to U.S. Junior Nationals.
   c. Technical and Free routines shall be considered final events.
   d. Junior Free routines in each event may be conducted as a combined group with the Senior Free routines, with no change in judges or scoring personnel during the routine event.
3. Junior Division Awards
   a. Medals shall be awarded for places 1-3 and ribbons shall be awarded for places 4-8 in each of the events noted under B.2.a.
   b. The West Zone shall award a High Point Award (plaque) to the Club with the highest total points earned in the Junior Championship.

C. **Junior/Senior Acrobatic Routine**

1. There shall be an Acrobatic Routine conducted as a 100% routine event. Competitors who are 13 and 14 years of age may compete in the Junior/Senior Acrobatic Routine. Routines including competitors who are 13 and 14 years of age are also eligible to participate in the Junior/Senior Acrobatic Routine at the combined U.S.

National Championship/U.S. Junior Championship; however, they must have passed Grade Level 5. At least 1 competitor in the Acrobatic Routine must be in the Junior or Senior Age division.

2. Medals shall be awarded for places 1-3 and ribbons shall be awarded for places 4-8 in the Acrobatic Routine event.

D. **Youth Championship**

1. Youth Division Qualifiers
   a. Athletes entering must be 13 to 15 (for females) and 13-16 (for males and for solo and duet gender inclusive competitors) years of age based on the year of birth.
      Exception: Competitors who are 12 years of age and younger may compete in Team and Free Combination routines. Routines including competitors who are 12 years of age and younger are also eligible to participate in Team and Free Combination routines at the U.S. Youth Championship; however, they must have passed Grade Level 4. At least 1 competitor in Team and Free Combination routines must be in the Youth Age division.
   b. There are no qualifying meets or scores for this competition.
   c. Honorary entries will be allowed in Figures but are not eligible to receive awards.
2. Youth Division Events
   a. All competitors in this division shall participate in Figures competition, with the Figure group to be drawn by the West Zone Technical Chair 48-72 hours prior to the start of the meet.
   b. The routine events shall consist of Solo (Women, Men, and Gender Inclusive), Duet (Women, Men, Gender Inclusive, and Mixed), Team, and Free Combination.
   c. Figure and routine scores shall be combined to determine final placement, and the appropriate number of qualified placements shall advance to the U.S. Youth Championship.
3. Youth Division Awards
   a. Medals shall be awarded for places 1-3 and ribbons shall be awarded for places 4-8 in each of the events noted under D.2.b.
   b. The West Zone shall award a High Point Award (plaque) to the Club with the highest total points earned in the Youth Championship.
   c. Additional Figures competition awards including the following:
      1) Medals for places 1-3 and ribbons for places 4-8.
      2) Ribbons for places 1-3 in each individual Figure among all 13-year-old competitors, among all 14-year-old competitors, and among all 15/16-year-old competitors. The names of these individuals will be announced during the awards ceremony, and they will stand in place, but not come up to the podium for their award, which will instead be placed in their coach's packet.

E. **Additional Entry Rules**

1. Athletes may enter multiple divisions (Senior, Junior, Youth) provided all qualifiers for each division entered are met.
2. Athletes entered in multiple divisions (Senior, Junior, Youth) must pay the entry fee in each division.
3. All listed alternates in any routine shall pay a $5 entry fee and shall receive an award as appropriate.

10.05 **Medals & Ribbons:** Each year the region hosting the West Zone Championships shall be responsible for supplying medals and ribbons to present to the athletes and shall maintain their own inventory of such until they again serve as the hosting organization.

10.06 **Late Entries:** Late entries to the West Zone Championships will be accepted at the discretion of the Host Organization, the Zone Chair, Zone Scoring Chair and Zone Technical Chair. There shall be a fine imposed upon any club whose late entry is accepted, payable to the Host Organization. The fine is defined in Appendix A.

10.07 **Late Payment of Entry Fees:**

A. There shall be a fine imposed for club entry payments not received by the West Zone Championships payment deadline. The fine is defined in Appendix A.

B. There shall be an additional fine imposed for club entry payments not received until arrival at the West Zone Championships. The fine is defined in Appendix A.

10.08 A. **Credentials Fee:** Free credentials for coaches/chaperones of a club will be allotted based on the number of athletes entered from that Club using the national meet structure (refer to current year's national meet announcements). Clubs shall be charged $5.00 for each additional credential requested. There shall be a limit of three (3) additional chaperone credentials beyond the national meet structure.

B. **Credentials Late Fee:** There shall be a fine imposed any for credentials requested "at the door" by coaches/chaperones who did not pre-register. The fine is defined in Appendix A.

10.09 **Digital Music Late Fee:** There shall be a fine imposed for any digital music submissions received or changes made after the due date noted in the WZ Championships meet announcement. The fine is defined in Appendix A.

10.10 **Coach Card Late Fee:** There shall be a fine imposed for any coach card submissions received or changes made after the due date noted in the WZ Championships meet announcement. The fine is defined in Appendix A. No Coach Cards submissions or changes shall be accepted within seven (7) days of the competition start date, except on medical grounds.

10.11 **Penalty for Non-Athletes in Competition Area:** A $100 fine may be assessed per incident against any person and/or club who has received one warning to leave the competition area and does not do so. Any monies collected will go to the West Zone.

10.12 **Foreign Federations:** Foreign federations may enter competitors in the West Zone Championships under the following conditions:

A. Foreign athletes may enter only with the written approval of their own Federation.

B. Each Federation/Club may enter only two (2) Technical Solos and two (2) Free Solos in each Solo event category (Women, Men, and Gender Inclusive), two (2) Technical Duets and two (2) Free Duets in each Duet event category (Women, Men, Gender Inclusive, and Mixed), one (1) Technical Team and one (1) Free Team, one Youth Free Combination, and one (1) Acrobatic Routine.

C. Foreign competitors shall receive an honorary award for their final placement. The West Zone competitors shall be listed in final placement and given awards without regard to the placement of foreign competitors.

APPENDIX E
WEST ZONE AWARDS CRITERIA AND NOMINATION FORM

EMAIL YOUR NOMINATION(S) TO IRENE HAWES AT synchroirene8@gmail.com

NOMINATION DEADLINE IS 01/31/2026

ATHLETE OF THE YEAR

- Motivated to work in a positive way toward their individual goals and those of their teammates/club and the sport.
- Personal attitude and habits that demonstrate a good image and role model to all athletes of the Zone and others involved in the sport.
- Recognition of swimming skills at, and qualifying for, national level competition.

COACH OF THE YEAR

- Works toward development of athletes and the sport without concern for self-promotion or personal gain.
- Develops and continues to carry out a consistent solid coaching program that benefits athletes and the sport.
- Recognition of coaching abilities at Zone and National qualifying levels.
- Sets an example in their attitude and ethics that inspire and motivate athletes to make the most of their abilities and potential to reach their goals.

CONTRIBUTOR OF THE YEAR

- Demonstrated interest in what is best, overall, for the athletes, those working in the sport, and for the sport at all levels - Association, Regional, Zone and beyond.
- Gives tirelessly of time, support, and care towards development of all aspects of the sport, without concern for a particular group, for self-promotion, or for personal gain.
- Helps to develop programs/methods to further all facets of the sport; i.e., administration, training, and/or volunteers at various duties required by the sport.
- Demonstrates an attitude that motivates others to work toward positive goals. Helps establish their area as a leader in providing the best of competitions at all levels, i.e., hosting of competitions, clinics, etc.

WEST ZONE AWARDS NOMINATIONS

Please note ***it is necessary*** to list background, reasons and credentials for nominating your candidate for the three categories. Use back of page.

1. WEST ZONE ATHLETE OF THE YEAR

   _____

2. WEST ZONE COACH OF THE YEAR

   _____

3. WEST ZONE CONTRIBUTOR OF THE YEAR

   _____

APPENDIX F
WEST ZONE AWARD WINNERS

Year	Athlete	Coach	Contributor
1993	Julie Davies	Julie Howell	Kay Davies Jackie McDaniel
1994	Casey Taylor	April Brennan Stallworth	Debbie Smith
1995	Kelli Bonzoumet	Lona Albano	Paulette Roche Ted Roche
1996	Tammy Crow Amy McDaniel	Jeanette Bacigalupo	Sheila MacNaughton
1997	Kimi Cochrun	Debbie Wilkenson	Bill Blockie
1998	Jess Trainer	Jill Starling	Christina Todd
1999	Sarah Jones	Lisa Velez	Betty Hazle
2000	Emily Marsh	Khadija Cutcher	Sheryl Velez
2001	Ashley McHugh	Lorette Haynes	Ed Kaminski
2002	Rachel Ranucci	Soo Hee	Norma Longmire
2003	Kim Probst	Cheryl Abrahams Russell	Dawn Bean
2004	Alia Arbas	Patty Andresen	Del Neel Kathryn Freer
2005	Katie Norris	Katie Tipton	Ann Murphy
2006	Kimiko Urata	Shannon Korpela	Cathy Gac
2007	Jillian Penner	Kellie Wasserman	Karen Rosolowski
2008	Bianca Johnson	Jill Parr	Laurette Longmire
2009	Raena Sumiyoshi Ashley Taylor	Anna Kozlova	Pam Edwards
2010	Lauren Nicholson	Marion Kane	Renee Miller
2011	Katy Wiita	Julie Thaden	Irene Hawes
2012	Jamie Kuchan	Sue Nesbitt	Patricia Jones
2013	Emily Wills	Becky Thompson Lorette Haynes	Sue Ahlf
2014	Elle Billman	Candy Hipp	Betty Hazle
2015	Elizabeth Wiita	Karen Rosolowski	Jeanne Struck Candy Kaemerer
2016	Nicole Johnson	Chris Carver	Nancy Thompson
2017	Andrea Percic	Hiea-Yoon Kang	Nancy Hines
2018	Natalie LaGrone	Irene Hawes Ludivine Perrin-Stsepaniuk	Candy Kaemerer
2019	Aivan Nguyen	Lucie Svrcinova	Christine McMaster-Shah
2020	Nikolett Szekely	Jessica Naranjo	Jackie McDaniel
2021	Heather Ding	Tammy McGregor	Karen Rosolowski
2022	Brianna Holmes Rachel Holmes	Bianca Van der Velden Sonja Van der Velden	Norma Longmire
2023	Sophia Wendt	Lorette Haynes	Nancy Thompson
2024	Elle Santana	Anna Yesipova	Sue Ahlf
2025	Dalia Ovadia	Daniela Garmendia	Katelyn Meyer Tori Hawes